Machete



Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Machete/Chopper

What it is used for

A machete or chopper is a heavy cutting tool used for vegetation and other suitable materials. Use it only for its intended purpose with a clear work area and controlled cutting technique.

How to use

1. Inspect the blade, handle, and fastening points for cracks, looseness, or damage.
2. Wear suitable protective clothing, sturdy footwear, and eye protection.
3. Clear the work area and ensure that other people remain well outside the cutting range.
4. Hold the handle firmly and maintain a stable stance before each cut.
5. Cut only suitable material using controlled strokes directed away from the body.
6. Stop before moving, clearing debris, or changing the cutting position.
7. Clean the blade, fit its sheath, and store the tool securely.

⚠ Safety

- Never swing the machete near another person or use it as a throwing tool.
- Keep hands and legs outside the blade's path.
- Do not use a damaged, loose-handled, or blunt tool that may slip unpredictably.
- Carry the machete with its blade sheathed and directed safely.

Care & storage

- Clean and dry the blade after use and apply suitable rust protection when recommended.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.